

Patron:  
His Excellency Sri Lanka Ambassador to  
the United States of America

## EOI for Conducting Capacity Needs Assessment of Pradeshiya Sabhas in the Eastern Province

### Introduction to SLWCS

For the past 12 years the Sri Lanka Wildlife Conservation Society (SLWCS) has been addressing one of the biggest environmental and socio-economic crises in Sri Lanka, which is human elephant conflicts (HEC). Today HEC is prevalent in 8 of the 9 administrative provinces and affects nearly 3 million people and results in nearly Rs.1,100 million (~US\$10 million) per annum in agriculture losses. The Society's innovative concepts to resolve HEC has benefitted close 165,000 people in Central, North Central, Eastern Provinces and System C of the Mahaweli Development Program. During this process and for projects in various other sectors of development and conservation we have worked in over 30% of Divisional Secretary Divisions (DSDs) of Sri Lanka and have resource utilization data from 1998 to 2009 from over 20% of the DSDs.

The Sri Lanka Wildlife Conservation Society is fully registered Sri Lankan non-governmental organization. It is also a fully incorporated non-profit, tax-exempt 501-3c organization in the U.S.A and registered not for profit organization in Australia. It was founded in 1995. The Society is highly committed to developing solutions to address sustainable livelihood, land use, and poverty alleviation and environmental conservation since these issues are all inextricably linked. **In 2008 the SLWCS was awarded a UNDP Equator Initiative Prize, which honors community-based projects that represent outstanding efforts to reduce poverty through the conservation and sustainable use of biodiversity.**

### Introduction to SLWCS in the Eastern Province

The Sri Lanka Wildlife Conservation Society (SLWCS) has been working in the Eastern Province for the past 5 years. In 2004 we initiated a project at the request of the Department of Wildlife Conservation to mitigate human elephant conflicts in 4 villages along the southern boundary of the Lahugala Kitulana National Park in the Ampara District. Since then we have established an agroforestry project, developed 640 home gardens, initiated a microfinance/credit program and provided agro and tube wells to villages in the Lahugala, Pottuvil and Panama areas. On behalf of UNESCO-SL we surveyed historic Seruwila in Trincomalee to assist in the Sri Lanka government's application to have Seruvila declared as a UNESCO World Heritage Site. In addition we have initiated sea turtle, human elephant conflict, poaching and natural resource use surveys in the Ampara District.

The Mission of the SLWCS includes;

- Protection of biodiversity in priority areas and the sustainable use of natural resources.
- Scientific and social research to develop practical development strategies at the grassroots level and to strengthen rural institutions to promote cooperative governance and community involvement in conservation, land use and livelihood development.
- Fostering partnerships between communities, funding agencies, private enterprises, industries, government institutions, and policy makers to develop a realistic model for sustainable development and biodiversity conservation.

### Ongoing Projects

1. **Saving Elephants by Helping People (SEHP):** a multi-faceted holistic approach to elephant conservation that combines human elephant conflict resolution, capacity building, economic development, alternative agriculture, field research and tourism. Initiated in 1997, the SEHP project concepts have been emulated by the Department of Wildlife Conservation, Mahaweli Authority and the Forest Department of Indonesia, Bengkulu Province, Sumatra.
2. **Wetland Conservation Project (WCP):** The WCP develops work plans to combine long term research with community based initiatives for wetland conservation. The SLWCS has conducted socio-economic and biodiversity baseline studies in three important and distinctly different wetlands in the country.
3. **GIS as a tool for conservation:** to further the knowledge and understanding of the dynamics of ecosystems and human dominated landscapes where wildlife survives to develop models for effective conservation planning at the local, regional, and national level. We are organizing training programs and symposiums for this.
4. **Outdoor Environmental Education and Program (OEEP):** an exciting interactive and experiential learning opportunity for children to study ecology, evolution, environment, sustainable development, and conservation in the field. The OEEP is approved by the Ministry of Education. Posters and books in all languages are produced under the OEEP.
5. **Captive Elephant Breeding Project:** to establish a pilot breeding program for the privately owned captive elephants using natural and artificial insemination methods. The project is in partnership with the Faculty of Veterinary Medicine and Animal Sciences of the University of Peradeniya and the Millennium Elephant Foundation.
6. **Systematic Surveys & Research:** Baseline surveys in all of Sri Lanka to gather data on resource utilization, threat assessments and biodiversity along with Project Evaluations where needed. Completed 20% of the DS Divisions of Sri Lanka including the Eastern Provi

### Organizational Structure and Management

The SLWCS has an adaptive management approach to administration and operations mainly to

meet the challenges of working in a crisis driven field. The founder and President spearhead the organization and its direction with support from an International Advisory Board, a team of national and international consultants, and a competent team of staff members based in Sri Lanka. The International Advisory Board provides strategic guidance for the Society, help builds partnerships with international organizations, help raise funds, and build relationships and networks with local organizations. In Sri Lanka the Advisory Board help to obtain permission and approvals from local authorities as needed. The consultants provide scientific and technical advice and guidance. The Sri Lankan managerial team is responsible for organizing the day to day needs of the Society and working with local authorities and communities to achieve the goals and objectives of each project. The field teams implement the projects along with foreign and local volunteers. Currently the Society has 23 staff members working on projects spread around the country. Additionally about 5-10 international and local volunteers work on projects assisting the field staff.

### Staff Summary

| <b>Employee category</b> | <b>No. of employees</b> | <b>Basis of employment (Permanent/Period part time / contract</b> | <b>of employment in the company</b> |
|--------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Field Research           | 9                       | Permanent                                                         | >5-10 years                         |
| Administration           | 4                       | Permanent                                                         | >5-10 years                         |
| Logistics                | 3                       | Permanent                                                         | >10 years                           |
| Finance                  | 2                       | Permanent                                                         | >10 years                           |
| Support staff            | 6                       | Permanent/temporary                                               | >10 years                           |

### List of Relevant References

The list of references provided below illustrates the organizations extensive experience in participatory community development initiatives at the grass root levels. SLWCS through there project interventions use Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA) and Rapid Rural Appraisal (RRA) to assess community needs and their capacities along with their willingness to improve their lives and their economic and environmental well being. Hence the successes of our community projects depend largely on regular baselines that are conducted prior to planning interventions. These baselines are followed by community needs assessments/ training needs assessments, projects design and implementation, regular internal monitoring and end of project evaluations (both by internal and by external consultants).

The participatory approaches we use are distinguished by the use of local graphic representations (through Venn diagrams, problem tree's, livelihood mapping, resource mapping, transect walk, focus group discussions, semi-structured interviews etc.) created by the community that legitimize local knowledge and promote empowerment and change. The knowledge that arises from these processes is shared with and owned by local people. Additionally these participatory processes transform us into learners and listeners, respecting local intellectual and analytical capabilities. And lastly the extensive and creative use of local materials and representations encourages visual sharing and enhances sensitivity through attention to process resulting in the

inclusion of marginal and vulnerable groups, women, children, aged, and destitute. In addition to communities, various socio-economic baselines and surveys have been conducted through dialogue, discussion and focus groups with Government officials such as Divisional Secretary (DS) officers, Grama Niladhari (GN) officers and Pradeshiya Sabah (PS) members.

These development initiatives are also largely the result of successful partnership with key Government and private stakeholders and institutions. SLWCS also taps into their key resource consultants that provide expertise in a variety of areas ranging from environmental to sociological issues.

1. July 2009 - REPORT - **"Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction thru Spatial and Temporal Approaches to Human-Elephant Conflict Mitigation"** by Chandee Corea, Ravi Corea and Samantha Mirandu. UNDP Disaster Management Symposium.
2. May 2008 – REPORT – **“Project Progress Report - Preliminary field surveys to assess the status of the endangered Dugong (Dugong dugon) and to record sea turtle nesting, poaching, by-catch mortalities and other threats in the Kalpitiya-Karaitive Puttalam Coastal Wetlands Complex”**. – By Chandee Corea
3. April 2008 – REPORT – DRAFT – **“GIS Based Rapid Ecological and Resource Utilisation Baseline Survey of the Lunugala Division of the Badulla District and Seruvila Division of the Trincomallee District”** By Chandee Corea, Ravi Corea, Lara Doherty, Samantha Mirandu, Upul Karunasinghe and Chinthaka Weerasinghe. UNESCO Sri Lanka and Government of Sri Lanka.
4. September 2007 – ARTICLE - **“Villages in, Elephants Out!”** – By Nimashi Amaleeta of the Nation on Sunday
5. July 2007 – REPORT - **“Saving Elephants by Helping People – Establishing Alternative Incomes through Agriculture Diversification to Develop Economic Buffers for Communities with Human Elephant Conflict – Project Orange Elephant Interim Report.”** – By Ravi Corea, Nishantha Dharmasiri, Chandima Fernando and Chandee Corea
6. February 2007 – REPORT – **“Lahugala "Saving Elephants by Helping People - Lahugala Extension Project - Phase 1, Electric Fence." -** By Nishantha Dharmasiri, Chandee Corea and Ravi Corea
7. January 2007 – REPORT -**“Human-Elephant Conflict - An Assessment of the Potential Success of the Lahugala Electric Fencing Project.”** – By Timothy Hancock
8. 2007 – REPORT – **“An Assessment of the Kalpitiya Karaitive Puttalam Coastal Complex with Recommendations for its water security issues.”** – By Chandee Corea, Chandima Fernando, Nishantha Dharmasiri, Ravi Corea, Zeenath Khalid
9. 2007 – REPORT – **“ Wasgamuwa, "Saving Elephants by Helping People" - Field Scouts Program Final Report.”** By Harsha Gamanpila, Chandee Corea and Ravi Corea (in draft)
10. October 2006 – DRAFT REPORT - **“Coastal Conservation by Helping People (CCHP): Alleviating Poverty by linking sustainable livelihood development to participatory coastal and marine resources conservation in the Southern Province of Sri Lanka.”** – By SLWCS
11. February 2006 – REPORT - **“Saving Elephants By Helping People – Report to the IUCN Asian Elephant Specialist Group.”** – By Ravi Corea
12. 2006 – REPORT – **“Flood Plains National Park - A socio-economic baseline survey.”** -

- By Zeenath Khalid, Nishantha Dharmasiri, Chandee Corea and Ravi Corea.
13. September 2005 – REPORT - **“SLWCS in Partnership with The Born Free Foundation – Assessment of Human Elephant Conflict in the North West Region of Sri Lanka.”** - By Zeenath Khalid, Nishantha Dharmasiri, Ravi Corea and Chandee Corea
  14. February 2005 – REPORT – **“The reconstruction and rehabilitation of a fishing community impacted by the December 26th 2004 Tsunami - A Project Funded by the Abercrombie and Kent Global Foundation.”** – By SLWCS
  15. 2005 – REPORT - **“Flood Plains National Park (FPNP) Socio-economic Component.”** – By Zeenath Khalid (Consultant Sociology) & Nishantha Dharmasiri, Secondary Investigator: Chandee Corea. Funded by IUCN Netherlands Committee. 2AS00046A
  16. 2004 – REPORT - **“2004 Annual Report – Sri Lanka Wildlife Conservation Society – 10th Anniversary Commemorative Issue 1995-2005.”**
  17. April 2004 – REPORT - **“Feasibility of Electric Fences to Keep Away Wild Elephants from Communities in order to minimize Human Elephant Conflict in area of high Human and Elephant Populations, Lahugala”** - By Nishantha Dharmasiri
  18. November 2004 –REPORT - **“Biodiversity Conservation through Improved Home Gardens.”** – By Nishantha Dharmasiri
  19. December 2003 - REPORT - "Field Scouts Program - A Program Evaluation" by Rebecca Sievers, Columbia University, USA.
  20. October 2003 – REPORT – **“Evaluation Report (Knowledge, attitude and perceptions, KAP Study) – of Village Communities with regard to Solar Electric Fencing set up for protection of Pusseleyaya /Gamburuoya village against wild elephants.”** – By Zeenath Khalid
  21. October 2003 – REPORT – **Social Impact Assessment (SIA) - “Prospects of Community Based Nature Tourism” In Veheragala-gama, Hibiliyakada & Irriyagas-ulpathe Villages of Wasgomuwa Region, Sri Lanka.”** – By Zeenath Khalid & Nishantha Dharmasiri
  22. PRESENTATION – **“Developing a sustainable model for the conservation of the Sri Lankan elephant (Elephas maximus maximus).”** – By Ravi Corea
  23. PRESENTATION – **“Establishing Baseline Socio-Ecological Data for Habitat Planning – Designing Corridors and Managed Elephant use Areas for Community-based Elephant and Biodiversity Conservation.”** – By Chandee Corea
  24. September 2003 – PRESENTATION - **“Saving Elephants by Helping People (SEHP)”- Lessons in Community Integrated Elephant Conservation.”** – By Chandee Corea, Symposium on Human Elephant Relationships and Conflict

#### Key Management and Operational Staff

1. Ravi Corea (President/CEO) (MSc in Environmental Science and Policy)
2. Devaraj Ratnam (Oceania Director and Technical Advisor)
3. Chandee Corea (Operations Director - GIS Specialist/Marine Biologist)
4. Nishantha Dharmasiri (Project Manager – MSc Agro-Forestry)
5. Samantha Mirandu (Assistant Research - BSc in Agriculture and Animal Sciences)
6. Upul Karunasinghe (BA in Statistics)

### Key Consultants

1. Professor Mangala De Silva (Senior Environmental/Biodiversity Expert)
2. Professor Padma De Silva (Senior Wetland and Marine Expert)
3. Mr. Edmund Wilson (Elephant, Ecology and Policy Expert)
4. Zeenath Khalid (Sociologist and Development Researcher)
5. Elizabeth Smith (Marketing and Management Expert)
6. Phil Buccellato (Greener Media) (Film and Media Expert)
7. Professor Sudarshan Seneviratne (Archaeology/Cultural Expert)
8. Anandalal Nanayakkara (Legal Counsel/Environmental Law Expert)
9. Professor Oswin Perera (Livestock and Agricultural Development Expert)
10. Andrew Ardoin (Wildlife Biologist / Grants Program Manager)

### Key Finances

**Income:** SLWCS income during the years 2006 to 2008 was primarily from grants. This was mainly because of the tremendous impact the war on terrorism had on the international volunteers program. The volunteer program saw a substantial decrease in numbers from 2007 onwards. During the financial year 2008, there was a 45% reduction of income compared to the previous year largely due to the prevailing war on terror and the global financial crisis.

A significant portion of the total income for the years 2007 and 2008, comprising 56% and 70% respectively was due to the Canadian International Development Agency Local Tsunami Recovery Fund grant. An overview of the CIDA project is given separately in the Annual Report.

**Expenses:** SLWCS's total expenditure has increased mainly due to macro economic factors such as local currency depreciation and high inflation. The expenditure has increased by approximately 20% over the previous year. As per the official data released by the Government of Sri Lanka, the inflation in the country during this period has been approximately 15%. Seventy percent of total annual income is spent on projects of the total annual revenue. On 30% is spent overhead and administrative expense.

**Net Assets:** Despite the difficult macro and global socio economic circumstances, the Net Assets of the SLWCS has increased from Rs. 6 million in 2006 to Rs. 9.5 million in 2008.

### Contact Person:

Chandeep Corea

### Registered Office Address:

38 Auburn Side, Dehiwala, Sri Lanka

Telephone/Fax:

011 2714710 and 0777885330

E-mail and Web:

[chandeepc@slwcs.org](mailto:chandeepc@slwcs.org), [info@slwcs.org](mailto:info@slwcs.org) and [www.SLWCS.org](http://www.SLWCS.org)